



INDIA'S WIN AGAINST AUSTRALIA REAFFIRMED THE WOMEN'S TEAM'S READINESS FOR THE LONGER FORMAT AND UNDERScoreD THE NEED TO INCORPORATE MORE TESTS IN BILATERAL TOURNAMENTS

Picture-perfect: India's win is its first in 11 women's Tests against No. 1-ranked Australia since the sides first played in 1977. There were notable performances from Jemimah Rodrigues (facing page) and Richa Ghosh (right). EMMANUAL YOGINI

readiness for the longer format and underscored the need to incorporate more Tests in bilateral tournaments.

According to the ICC's Future Tours Programme for 2022-2025, India women won't play any Tests till March 2025. There will be a Women's Premier League (WPL), a T20 World

Cup, and three bilateral series — an away outing against Australia in December next year, followed by home assignments against the West Indies and Ireland — in between. "The girls certainly need more Test matches and not one-off assignments," said former India captain and coach Sudha Shah. "Ideally, it should be a three-match series."

Sudha was part of the Indian team that played its first-ever Test against Australia in Perth

in 1977 under the leadership of Shantha Rangaswamy. Against an experienced Australian team, the Indians lost by 147 runs. Sudha believes the current crop needs to ride on the momentum and play as many Tests as possible. "The girls now know they can beat stronger teams. That certainly gives them confidence. It's a good thing for the

